

Live babies

In summer, two months or so after mating, the mother gives birth to 3–11 baby lizards. In warmer places, the females may produce eggs instead of live young.

The babies are born inside thin membranes that break either during birth or soon afterward.

Off they go

The newborn lizards are able to fend for themselves. They soon scamper off to live independently. Males by the age of two, and females by the age of three, will be mature enough to breed.

Hibernation

Viviparous lizards in cooler regions hibernate in fall, underground or in a sheltered place such as a pile of logs. In warmer climates, the lizards remain active all year round.

Jackson's chameleon

A chameleon is a type of lizard. Most chameleons lay eggs, but Jackson's chameleon is one of the few exceptions. The female has up to 35 babies five to six months after mating. The male looks very striking, with three horns on its head.

See also

Find out about another cold-blooded animal that also gives birth to live young—the lemon shark (88–89).

